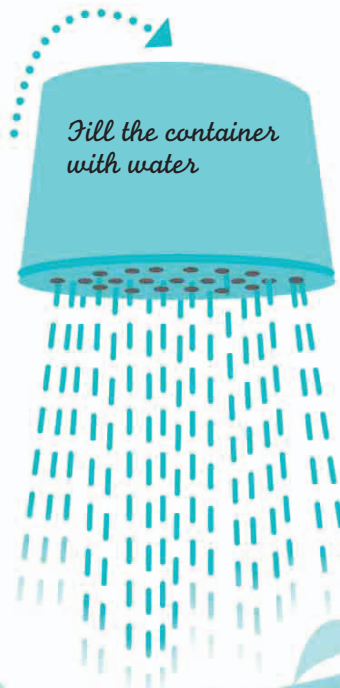


Simple shower

Punch some holes in the lid of a plastic food container (a cottage cheese container with a tight-fitting lid is ideal) using a metal skewer. Half-fill the tub with water, replace the lid, and show your baby how to turn the tub upside down to sprinkle water over his tummy, knees, and feet. With this bath time fun, he'll be practicing his fine motor skills and learning about cause and effect.



8
MONTH

Off-peak soft play

Your baby's muscle control and coordination is increasing all the time, and he's also becoming more aware of different environments, so he may be ready to try out a soft play gym. Pick a quiet time to go—maybe during school hours, or early in the day. The ball pool is a good place to start: get in together, hold him safely in your arms, and swish him around gently.